

Юмор, воспоминания и эмоциональные моменты: что запомнилось из выступлений членов Зала славы НФЛ



Слева направо: Ларри Фицджеральд, Адам Винатъери, Люк Куэчли, Роджер Крейг и Дрю Бриз позируют для фото во время церемонии включения в Зал славы профессионального футбола. Ник Кэмметт / Getty Images



By **Saad Yousuf**

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В субботу Зал славы профессионального футбола официально принял в свои ряды пять новых членов.

на то, что он имел на это право в течение первого года, класс 2026 года стал одним из самых обсуждаемых в новейшей истории. В него вошли пять человек, все — игроки. Квотербек Дрю Бриз, лайнбекер Люк Кюигли, ресивер Ларри Фицджеральд и кикер Адам Винатъери стали членами Зала славы в современную эпоху, а раннинбек Роджер Крейг был включен в Зал славы в свой 28-й год участия в выборах.

Брис, Куэчли, Фицджеральд и Винатъери произнесли речи вживую на сцене, а Крейг присутствовал, но его речь была записана заранее. В ней он рассказал, что [у него диагностировали деменцию](#). Речи включали в себя множество воспоминаний, беззаботный юмор и эмоциональные моменты. Вот что запомнилось от каждого игрока, когда они выходили на сцену, чтобы получить свои золотые майки:

Дрю Бриз, квотербек

Драфт: выбран во втором раунде драфта 2001 года (32-й номер)

Игровая карьера: 2001–2005, «Сан-Диего Чарджерс». 2006–2020, «Нью-Орлеан Сэйнтс»

Основные достижения в карьере: чемпион Супербоула и MVP Супербоула. В 2006 году вошел в первую сборную всех звезд, дважды признавался лучшим атакующим игроком. 13 раз попадал в Пробоул. Семь раз лидировал в НФЛ по ярдам пасом, шесть раз — по проценту

Из речи: Брис был последним выпускником 2026 года, кто произнес свою речь, и она была самой продолжительной за весь день. В [25-минутной речи](#) Брис рассказал о том, какую важную роль в его успехе сыграло воспитание, которое он получил как на поле, так и за его пределами, в кругу семьи и тренеров. Брис также уделил время размышлениям о своем пребывании в Новом Орлеане, где он провел большую часть своей карьеры в НФЛ.

«Не нужно много времени, чтобы понять, что делает Новый Орлеан таким особенным, — сказал Брис. — Новый Орлеан многое пережил, и в некоторых случаях казалось, что мы потеряли все. Возможно, он уже никогда не станет прежним. Штормы учат нас, что наши главные сокровища — это не вещи, которыми мы владеем. Это люди, которых мы любим, и то, как мы проявляем себя друг для друга». Это напоминает нам о том, что нужно прижимать своих близких чуть крепче, любить чуть сильнее, смеяться чуть громче и никогда не принимать ни один день как должное».

Люк Куэчли, лайнбекер

Игровая карьера: 2012–2019, «Каролина Пантерз»

Career highlights: Five-time First-Team All-Pro, Defensive Player of the Year in 2013. Selected to seven consecutive Pro Bowls from 2013-2019 and led the NFL in tackles twice. Helped the Panthers to a Super Bowl appearance in 2015. Selected to the Hall of Fame in second year of eligibility.

From the speech: Kuechly spent a lot of time thanking people from throughout his life, including his “first team,” which was his family, as well as various individuals from his football journey. Kuechly also [talked about what football brought him](#) and what he misses about it.

“The relationships formed through football are unique,” Kuechly said. “You see each other at your best, and you see each other at your worst. You spend long days together in meeting rooms. You learn how different people communicate, lead and overcome challenges. Over time, teammates become friends and friends become family. That’s why when people ask me what I miss most about football, it’s not one specific game or one specific play. It’s the locker room, which I feel like I have again with you guys (fellow Hall of Famers) up here.”

“It’s the conversations that have nothing to do with sports. It’s celebrating together after wins and hurting together after losses. There’s no way to measure what the game of football has given to me, the joy it’s provided and, more than anything, the people I have been so blessed to be around as a result of this game.”

Larry Fitzgerald, WR

Draft: 2004 first-round pick (No. 3 pick)

Playing career: 2004-2020, Arizona Cardinals

Career highlights: Led the league in receptions twice and led the league in receiving touchdowns twice. First-Team All-Pro in 2008. Helped the Cardinals to a

From the speech: Playing in an era that spotlighted flamboyant wide receivers such as Randy Moss, Terrell Owens and Chad Johnson, Fitzgerald took a more soft-spoken approach and let his play do the talking.

[In his speech](#), Fitzgerald showed more of his personality. He thanked Hall of Fame wide receiver and mentor Cris Carter, while saying he always had better hands than Carter. He thanked Randy Moss, complimenting the fellow Hall of Famer by saying he couldn't learn anything from Moss because Moss was such a unique talent. He referenced Emmitt Smith's wrestling skills in the locker room and Kurt Warner's love for spaghetti, while thanking both for their mentorship.

Fitzgerald thanked many people, from former coaches and teammates. He also honored his late mother, Carol, who passed away from breast cancer in 2003 and his late father, Larry Sr., [who passed away this summer](#). He finished his speech with words of wisdom to his children.

"The one thing I want you boys to remember most from everything you've heard: surround yourself with people who tell you what you need to hear, not what you want to hear," Fitzgerald said. "Those are the people who actually love you. Copy their examples. And remember, there's never much traffic on the extra mile in life. Bring others along with you. Don't just pursue excellence for yourself; help others pursue it, too. That's the part of this story that matters the most."

Adam Vinatieri, K

Draft: Undrafted

Playing career: 1996-2005, New England Patriots. 2006-2019, Indianapolis Colts

Career highlights: Four-time Super Bowl champion, known for making clutch kicks, including two in the snowy Tuck Rule Game during the 2001 divisional round and game-winning field goals in two Super Bowls. Three-time First-Team All-Pro and three-time Pro Bowler. Holds the record for most field goals made in a career, most consecutive field goals made, most combined regular season and postseason games played and is the league's career scoring leader. Selected to the Hall of Fame in second year of eligibility.

From the speech: Vinatieri [spoke for nearly 20 minutes](#) and delivered a speech that had a little bit of everything. In thanking various teammates from his 24 seasons in the NFL, Vinatieri took playful jabs at legends, such as Tom Brady and Peyton Manning. He joked about Drew Bledsoe being the best quarterback in Patriots history, then added he didn't want to make more jokes about Brady out of fear he would give Vinatieri a "Will Smith" slap, the way he recently did to Logan Paul. He thanked Manning for donating his "gigantic" forehead as the teleprompter for his speech. Vinatieri also joked that Bill Belichick couldn't make it because he's judging his girlfriend's cheerleading competition and that his former teammate Pat McAfee is the "only person who enjoyed holding my balls more than my wife."

Vinatieri had plenty of sincere moments as well, including ending his speech with an open letter to the sport.

"I want to thank the game of football," Vinatieri said. "Football, it would be so easy for me to forget to tell you how much you mean to me. If you were sitting here in the crowd today, this is what I would say. 'I loved you with everything I had. There was a time when I thought I wanted you more than air, but I was wrong. You were the air. You gave me purpose. You gave me direction. You gave me a life I could have never imagined. The beautiful thing about our relationship is that the more that I gave to you, the more you gave back to me. The more I devoted myself to you, the more you rewarded me. The more I committed to you, the more you committed to me.'"

Roger Craig, RB

Draft: 1983 second-round pick (No. 49 overall)

Playing career: 1983-1990, San Francisco 49ers. 1991, Los Angeles Raiders. 1992-1993, Minnesota Vikings.

he became the first player to top 1,000 yards rushing and receiving in the same season. Selected to the Hall of Fame in his 28th year of eligibility.

From the speech: Craig was present in Canton, but he didn’t deliver a speech from the stage. After he unveiled his Hall of Fame bust alongside his son, Roderick Craig, and his longtime teammate and presenter, Jamie Williams, a [10-minute prerecorded video played](#). Craig spent most of the time reflecting on his football journey, including former coaches and teammates, and his role in the 49ers’ dynasty in the ’80s. At the end of his speech, Craig [revealed that he has been diagnosed with vascular dementia](#).

“I want people to know this diagnosis doesn’t define me,” Craig said. “I am still Roger Craig. I am still a father, a husband, a teammate, a friend and someone who loves this game and the people who brought it to my life. If sharing my story helps even one family or one former player, then it’s worth it. Football gave me everything.”

Saad Yousuf is a staff writer covering the NFL. He previously covered the Dallas Cowboys and the Dallas Stars at The Athletic. Saad also works at 96.7/1310 The Ticket in Dallas after five years at ESPN Dallas radio. Prior to The Athletic, Saad covered the Cowboys, Mavericks and a variety of other sports at The Dallas Morning News.

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